One of them was a Provisional Arrangement Concerning the Status of Refugees coming from Germany in 1936. This Arrangement helped to issue travel documents to the German and the stateless.[*] The League further adopted another Convention Concerning the status of Refugees coming from Germany. They were partially able to tackle refugee crisis. When the United Nations was formed after dissolution of the League, on 24 October, 1945, the International Refugee Organization (IRO) was established [UNGA Resolution: Question of refugees, G.A res.8/1, (Feb.12, 1946)].

The IRO made attempts towards resettlement of displaced people in Europe in various countries like USA, Canada and Australia. Huge volume of refugee generated in the aftermath of Second World War (WWII) necessitated a more apt body to address the refugee problem. Therefore, the statute of the Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR) was adopted by the UN General Assembly (UNGA) on 14 December, 1950. It became operative from 1 January, 1951. This was followed by the adoption of the Convention Relating to the Status of Refugees on 28 July, 1951. This Convention came into force on 22 April, 1954.

The 1951 Refugee Convention defines a refugee as a person who “as a result of events occurring before 1 January, 1951 and owing to well-founded fear of being persecuted for reasons of race, religion, nationality, membership of a particular social group of political opinion, is outside the country of his nationality and is unable or, owing to such fear, is unwilling to avail himself of the protection of that country; or who, not having a nationality and being outside the country of his former habitual residence as a result of such events, is unable or owing to such fear, is unwilling to return to it.” Those who have committed crimes against peace, war crimes, crimes against humanity, or serious nonpolitical crimes abroad are exempted from the category of refugees.

Therefore, a timeline and a geographic location are present along with causes of moving out of one’s country. This was the heydays of Cold War and people were fleeing East Europe out of fear of communism. Thus, one of the causes as political opinion had been added. Later, the Protocol Relating to the Status of Refugees of 31